

Application for Junior Cyber Security Analyst

Dear WHSmith Recruitment Team,

I am applying for the Junior Cyber Security Analyst role at WHSmith Europe in Aldgate. The breadth of the role is what attracts me: monitoring and incident response alongside vulnerability management, governance and security awareness means I would build a rounded foundation rather than a narrow specialism, and I am based in London.

I hold an MSc in Information Security from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, and a BCA in computer applications, along with CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity. My MSc covered cryptography, security management, critical infrastructure security, secure business architectures and digital forensics. I also built a phishing analysis prototype that highlights suspicious email indicators and maps findings to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, which is the hands-on project work your advert lists as desirable.

The day-to-day duties overlap closely with what I already do. In my current IT support role I investigate four to five suspicious emails daily, checking sender and link domains for impersonation, documenting findings and alerting colleagues to recurring phishing tactics. I manage four to five access requests a day through Active Directory with a clear audit trail, and support user access reviews by verifying business approval before granting time-limited permissions. I am the first point of contact for 15 colleagues, monitor server health and maintain access controls. Outside work I built a diagnostic tool that traces Windows error codes to root causes and used it to identify missing and corrupted DLLs behind intermittent server freezes.

I should be straightforward about where I am starting from. I have not worked with a commercial SIEM or run vulnerability scans at scale, so those would be new. What I bring is comfort with frameworks rather than only tools, having studied ISO 27001, PCI DSS, GDPR and the NIST Cybersecurity Framework, and a track record of completing repetitive checks to a consistent standard. At Co-op I conduct weekly risk assessments and daily compliance checks, maintain the assessment records and follow up until identified risks are addressed, which is the discipline governance work depends on. I also introduced documentation that cut incident management time by more than half.

What draws me to WHSmith is that the advert values aptitude and curiosity over qualifications on paper, and that the team invests in development. That matches how I have built my skills so far, largely through self-directed work alongside formal study. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to your Information Security team. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

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